

Risk assessment plan

School/workplace	Newcastle High School			Condition, task, activity or event	Full-day music excursion: Attendance at the Sydney Symphony Orchestra Daytime Schools Concert at the Sydney Opera House, including return travel by chartered coach from school to Circular Quay and supervised participation in a live orchestral performance and related educational activities.
Principal/workplace manager	NA				
Assessed by	NA	Date	NA	Location	Sydney Opera House
Approved by	NA	Date	NA	Review date	NA
WHS Risk Register update	NA	Date	NA	Prepared in consultation with	NA

Risk Management process

Hazard/s	Risk/s	Risk rating	Control action/s	Risk rating after controls	Responsible	Due	Complete
What presents the potential risk to health and/or safety?	What might happen, how likely is it and what could be the consequence/s?	Apply WHS Risk Matrix	What action/s will be taken to eliminate the risk/s or at least reduce them to an acceptable level?	Apply WHS Risk Matrix	Who is responsible for putting controls in place?	When should the controls be put in place?	When were controls implemented?
Coach transport to and from Sydney	Vehicle accident, breakdown, or delayed return needing extended supervision needs. Likelihood: Unlikely; Consequence: Major.	High	Use NSW DoE-approved charter company with current maintenance and insurance Confirm driver accreditation and rest breaks. Seatbelts to be worn at all times Carry first-aid kit and emergency contact list.	Medium	Excursion Coordinator/ School Manager	Two weeks before excursion	Date of excursion
Movement through busy public areas (school to coach, Opera House forecourt, Circular Quay)	Students may become separated, lost, or injured in crowds. Likelihood: Possible; Consequence: Moderate.	High	Maintain 1:15 staff–student ratio. Allocate staff to front/rear of group and roll mark at key points. Provide all students with staff mobile numbers and meeting points.	Low	Supervising Teachers	On day of excursion	On day of excursion
Opera House venue hazards (stairs, seating, slips/trips)	Trip, slip, or fall causing injury. Likelihood: Possible; Consequence: Moderate.	Medium	Follow Sydney Opera House school safety briefing. Ensure students wear enclosed, non-slip footwear. •	Low	Supervising Teachers	Pre-departure briefing & day of excursion	On day of excursion

Hazard/s	Risk/s	Risk rating	Control action/s	Risk rating after controls	Responsible	Due	Complete
			Staff to monitor stairwells and aisles during entry and exit.				
Medical or health emergencies	Asthma attack, allergic reaction, or other medical issue. Likelihood: Possible; Consequence: Major.	High	Collect updated medical/consent forms and emergency contacts. At least one staff member with current first-aid and anaphylaxis training. Carry students' required medication (e.g., EpiPens, inhalers).	Medium	First-Aid Trained Staff & Excursion Coordinator	Prior to excursion	On day of excursion
Behavioural issues / non-compliance	Disruption, unsafe behaviour, or refusal to follow instructions leading to injury or missed transport. Likelihood: Possible; Consequence: Moderate.	Medium	Pre-excursion student briefing on behaviour expectations and consequences. Clear supervision plan and roll marking at each transition. Contact parents/guardians if serious behaviour occurs.	Low	Supervising Teachers	Pre-excursion briefing	On day of excursion

Risk matrix and evaluation

Table 1: THE WHS RISK MATRIX

		CONSEQUENCE (Severity)				
LIKELIHOOD (Probability)		Insignificant 1	Minor 2	Moderate 3	Major 4	Critical 5
		No treatment required.	Injury/illness requiring first aid treatment only.	Injury/illness requiring hospitalisation on going treatment.	Life-threatening injury/illness or multiple hospitalisations.	Death or multiple life-threatening injuries.
Almost certain 5	Expected to occur in most circumstances.	MEDIUM 5	HIGH 10	EXTREME 15	EXTREME 20	EXTREME 25
Likely 4	High probability of occurring in most circumstances.	MEDIUM 4	MEDIUM 8	HIGH 12	EXTREME 16	EXTREME 20
Possible 3	Might occur occasionally.	LOW 3	MEDIUM 6	HIGH 9	HIGH 12	EXTREME 15
Unlikely 2	Could occur at some time, doubtful.	LOW 2	MEDIUM 4	MEDIUM 6	MEDIUM 8	HIGH 10
Rare 1	May occur but only in exceptional circumstances.	LOW 1	LOW 2	LOW 3	MEDIUM 4	MEDIUM 5

Table 2: WHS Risk Evaluation

Risk level	Acceptability	Priority for action to control risk	Sign-Off Authority: Schools	Sign-Off Authority: Other workplace
Low 1-3	Acceptable	PROCEED while monitoring existing controls. Manage the exposure to the hazard using existing procedures in consultation with workers and respond to any changes.	School Principal or delegate	Immediate Supervisor or Workplace Manager
Medium 4-8	Tolerable	PROCEED with the activity and/or allow the hazard to persist only after identifying and implementing any additional controls reasonably practicable. Monitor all controls and manage the exposure to the hazard using existing procedures in consultation with workers and respond to any changes.	School Principal or delegate	Senior Manager or Director
High 9-14	Unacceptable	DO NOT PROCEED and/or allow the hazard to persist until all risks/hazards are identified and the most effective control methods are documented in a risk assessment. Seek support from the workplace manager and WHS Advisor or the Incident Report and Support Hotline.	Principal to sign off. Principal to talk to staff about eliminating or reducing the risk, and contact: - Health, Safety & Staff Wellbeing Directorate for review - Legal as required.	Executive Director or delegate to talk to staff about eliminating or reducing the risk and contact: - Health, Safety & Staff Wellbeing Directorate for review - Legal as required.
Extreme 15+	Unacceptable	STOP IMMEDIATELY and contact your WHS Advisor or the Incident Report and Support Hotline to plan a coordinated response in consultation with key subject matter experts to eliminate or control exposure to the hazard.	Principal to advise staff about eliminating or reducing the risk, and contact: - Director Educational Leadership for review - Health, Safety & Staff Wellbeing Directorate for review - Legal as required.	Executive Director or delegate to advise staff about eliminating or reducing the risk, and contact: - Health, Safety & Staff Wellbeing Directorate for review - Legal as required.

Hierarchy of controls

CONTROL	EFFECTIVENESS	DESCRIPTION	EXAMPLES
ELIMINATION	BEST	Eliminate the hazard entirely.	Eliminating the risk of a fall from height by doing the work at ground level.
SUBSTITUTION	VERY GOOD	Substitute the hazard with safer options.	Replacing hazardous cleaning chemicals with equivalent non-toxic products.
ISOLATION	GOOD	Isolate the hazard from causing harm.	Placing a barrier around an area of wet floor as a slipping hazard.
ENGINEERING	GOOD	Use engineering controls to reduce the risk.	Installing guards, rails, or handrails to prevent falls.
ADMINISTRATIVE	POOR	Administrate and document safe work practices.	Training workers in safe work procedures, Safe Operating Procedures.
PPE	WORST	Protect workers with Personal Protective Equipment (PPE).	Providing goggles and gloves to people handling hazardous chemicals.